LITTLE WONDERS ESL

History Word Lab: The Industrial Revolution

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · machines change the world



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. We are large buildings with machines. People work in us to make goods quickly.
2. I am hot water gas. I powered the engines of the first trains and factories.
3. I am a track for trains. I carried goods and people across the country.

2 COOL FACT: STEAM, COAL AND FACTORIES

The **Industrial Revolution** began in Britain in the 1700s and changed how people lived and worked. Before this time, most people lived in villages and made things by hand. Then inventors built **machines** that used **steam engines**, which burned **coal**. Workers in a factory made cloth and other goods quickly. James Watt improved the steam engine, and **railways** carried goods and people across the country. Cities grew fast, because many people moved there to find jobs. Many workers, including children, worked long hours in dangerous conditions. Later, new laws made **factories** safer.

inventors = people who make new things

conditions = the things around people that affect their lives

cloth = soft material that people use to make shirts and dresses

laws = rules that everyone must follow

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

T	F	E	M	R	R	U	A	V	S	Y	B
N	R	N	S	W	T	H	Q	F	I	P	R
K	S	G	R	A	I	L	W	A	Y	U	I
H	T	I	S	A	E	E	S	C	G	Z	T
V	E	N	G	S	N	B	I	T	E	N	A
M	A	E	T	A	S	C	L	O	T	H	I
E	M	A	C	H	I	N	E	R	G	T	N
U	H	O	F	C	O	A	L	Y	A	S	E

WORD BANK

- ☐ **factory**
- ☐ **steam**
- ☐ **railway**
- ☐ **engine**
- ☐ **machine**
- ☐ **Britain**
- ☐ **cloth**
- ☐ **coal**

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. Where did the Industrial Revolution begin?
2. What did steam engines burn?
3. What was life like for many factory workers?